

Pronunciation

B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

C = /k/ (cake) · H = /h/ or soft rasp · J = /dʒ/ (jello) · R = /r/ flap (American butter)

Vowels: A /ɑ/ (father) · E /ɛ/ (cellar) · I /i/ (creek) · O /ɔ/ (door) · U /u/ (flu)

E and O closed like Spanish are fine too.

Stress: penultimate syllable — iLlru

1. Pronouns and Possession

	singular	plural
1st	nim I	nima we
2nd	run you	runa you (pl)
3rd	hay he / she / they	haya they (pl)

Pronouns are often dropped when context is clear. Affirmative sentences default to nim, and questions to run, so you don't repeat them as much as in English.

Possessive: pronoun before the word · for nouns, use de

nim bo = my house

bo de miwo = dog's house

2. The Four Core Markers

a [subject] · i [verb] · e [direct object] · u [indirect object]

Mnemonics: Actor · Initiates · Engaged · Unto

a nim i anona e mocen u run

I give chocolate to you

More often (nim dropped in affirmative): i anona e mocen u run

You may drop markers when context is clear. a drops the easiest, and then e.

a...a means is / are:

a hay a yalen = he/she/they is tall · a bo a yamirli = the house is old

Word order is flexible because roles are marked: e mocen u run i anona is also common.

3. Describing Words

A modifier goes right before the word it describes.

mocen mouje = chocolate drink

pohem mocen mouje = hot chocolate drink

4. Two Core Prepositions

en = location / time ("in, on, at")

de = source / possession ("of, from")

a run en bo = you are at home

a hay i anifi de bo = he/she/they comes from the house

5. Coordination and Contrast

su	and / with	run i mo e moaria su mocen	you eat apple and chocolate
mai	but	hay i anvu, mai nim i doum	she goes, but I don't
dou	or	nim i mo e moaria dou mocen	I eat apple or chocolate
eta	so, therefore	a nim a tou, eta nim i bonfene	I'm tired, so I lie down

6. Negation

Add -um to the word you want to negate.

i dami a moaria = there is an apple

i damium a moaria = there is no apple

7. Questions and "what/that" Clauses

Raise intonation for yes/no questions. No structural change.

run i mo? = are you eating?

ce = what (question) · ca = that / which (connector)

ce en bo? = what's in the house?

Build more question words with ce + a domain word:

word	meaning
cei	who (what + person)
cedom	where (what + place)
celi	when (what + time)
ceora	why (what + reason)
cenon	how (what + way)

In statements, swap ce → ca: ceora → caora (because) · cedom → cadom (where) · etc.

run i ilianum cadom bo = you know-not where the house

8. Verb Stacking

To chain two verbs, repeat i before each one. No "to" needed.

run i dairan i anelem en bo = you like to stay home

hay i do i mo = he/she/they can eat

haya i dai i anvu = they want to go

9. Compounds

-a suffix bonds modifiers and noun into a single concept:

waa jasru	waa (sea) + jasru (bend)	= bay
lufua bei	lufua (air) + bei (vehicle)	= airplane
yalgaia mus	yalgaia (small) + mus (bug)	= ant
waa dom	waa (sea) + dom (land)	= island

Hyphenated forms fuse two words into one expression:

falen-li	falen (child) + li (time)	= childhood
tohp-vanvu	tohp (sad) + vanvu (walk)	= to trudge
bo-bortal	bo (house) + bortal (enter)	= to enter a house

If you're unsure which form to use, just use whatever feels right. Chances are, either works!

10. Vocabulary

Most Oravia words are formed as (sub)cluster + root. A cluster is the first sound(s) and signals the semantic domain; a root adds a second layer of meaning.

moalen (banana) = MO (food) + A (fruit subcluster) + LEN (root: long)

~260 (sub)clusters and roots were discovered using word-embeddings. Once you know the patterns, you can make educated guesses and learn words faster.

Starter Vocabulary

mo	eat / food	bo	house	beivu	car	leirih	tree
falen	child	fare	parent	faejor	woman	faejal	man
faibor	spouse	eofa	friend	elihei	person	anye	make, do
anvu	go	anona	give	anifou	need	ando	can
none	have	anidai	want	dami	exist	dairan	like
ilian	know	ilaluan	speak	elemi	live, life	yuba	good
ti	bad	yalen	tall/long	litam	day	liyar	morning
noli	now	noi	here / this	ho noi	there / that	oipoh	exciting

AN	action <i>PIE *h₂en- (to breathe/live)</i>	ELA	religious <i>Aramaic Elah (God)</i>	ILO	when knowledge is uncertain <i>English illusion</i>
ANE	static movement <i>Latin manere (to remain/stay)</i>	ELE	self-expansion <i>Greek ἐλευθερος (eleutheros = free, self...)</i>	IRAN	favor
ANI	movement towards <i>Latin animus (directed will)</i>	ELI	virtue <i>Greek ἠθικός (ethikos = ethical)</i>	JA	tools <i>Arabic jihāz (apparatus, equipment)</i>
ANO	movement away <i>Japanese ano (that, over there)</i>	ELO	prosocial <i>Latin eloqui (to speak out)</i>	JAE	container <i>Portuguese/Spanish/Arabic jarra (large c...</i>
APA	physical movement <i>Sanskrit apad (to move on foot)</i>	EO	social <i>Greek εὖ- (eu = good, social prefix)</i>	JAH	cutting tools <i>Japanese ha/ja = blade, edge)</i>
AS	involuntary bodily functions <i>PIE *h₁es- (to be, to exist)</i>	EOD	social interactions <i>Japanese deau (meet)</i>	JAS	gripping and fastening tools <i>Japanese hasamu (clamp, pinch)</i>
ASE	affectionate contact <i>Sanskrit āśleṣa (embrace, close contact)</i>	EOM	events and gatherings <i>Korean moim (gathering, meeting)</i>	JE	geometrics <i>Mandarin (jié = joint, geometric section)</i>
ASI	orifice intake and expulsion <i>Sanskrit āśya (mouth)</i>	FA	family relationships <i>Latin familia (family)</i>	JEN	location <i>Japanese (zen/jen front location)</i>
ASU	involuntary vocal acts <i>Sanskrit asu (breath, vital force)</i>	FAE	gender	JEO	geometric positions <i>Greek γεω- geo (geography, geometry)</i>
BE	travel <i>Bengali berano (to roam, travel)</i>	FAI	partnership, marriage <i>Latin foedus (pact, partnership)</i>	JO	materials <i>Korean jaeryo (material)</i>
BEI	vehicles	FAL	young ones <i>Latin filia, filius (children)</i>	JOL	material types
BO	home interior <i>Arabic (bayt = house, dwelling)</i>	FE	halting <i>Turkish fren (brake)</i>	JU	deceive <i>Hindi jhūṭh (lie, deception)</i>
BOE	house spaces <i>English bower (chamber, private room),...</i>	FEI	less	JUI	temporary <i>Hindi/Urdu jugār (makeshift, temporary f...</i>
BON	furniture <i>French banc (bench, table-like furniture)</i>	FENE	rest	LA	happiness <i>across unrelated languages as an expre...</i>
BOR	house structure <i>English bore/board (structural element)</i>	FI	inside <i>Swahili -fika (to arrive, come)</i>	LAN	balance <i>Hindi saṃtūlana (balance, equilibrium)</i>
BOS	hygiene fixtures <i>Malay basuh (to wash)</i>	FIVA	cold	LANO	around
CAI	flat <i>Sanskrit caya (flat layer)</i>	FOU	lack <i>English few</i>	LARO	continuation
CATI	constraint <i>Latin catena (chain, constraint)</i>	FU	lightness <i>Mandarin fú (floating, light)</i>	LE	environment <i>PIE *lendh- (open land, heath)</i>
CE	what? <i>Latin quid (what) and Romance que/ce</i>	GA	evaluation <i>English gauge</i>	LEA	landscape <i>English lea (open meadow, landscape ty...</i>
CI	sharp <i>Mandarin cì (to stab, prick, sharp)</i>	GAI	small <i>English grain of sand</i>	LEI	plants <i>Mandarin (lèi = flower bud, plant growth)</i>
CIU	creative products <i>English creative, Latin creatus (produced)</i>	GALI	coffee <i>Arabic qahwa (coffee)</i>	LEM	keeping <i>Greek λήμμα lēmma (something taken a...</i>
CO	communication <i>Latin communicare (to communicate)</i>	GAN	ranking <i>Japanese (kaku/gan proximity = rank, gr...</i>	LEN	long <i>Latin longus (long)</i>
COU	written communication <i>French courier (mail, correspondence)</i>	GAO	value assessment	LENO	ground <i>Spanish llano (flat ground)</i>
DA	evaluation <i>Arabic dhā (this, that, referential)</i>	GAR	bear	LEO	belonging
DAE	epistemic <i>Japanese (dai = declaration, evidence, p...</i>	GE	finances <i>Proto-Germanic *geldan (to pay)</i>	LI	time <i>Mandarin / li (calendar)</i>
DAI	desire	GEL	trading <i>German Geld/gelten (to be worth, to tra...</i>	LIA	resonant <i>Hindi laya (rhythm, resonance)</i>
DAL	pattern <i>Swahili dalili (sign, indication, pattern)</i>	GI	boldness <i>Hindi jigar (courage, heart)</i>	LIL	muscle <i>Arabic lif (fiber)</i>
DAN	emphasis <i>Mandarin (dàn = but, emphatic contrast)</i>	GO	half <i>Japanese go (five, half of ten)</i>	LIMEL	evening <i>Arabic layl (night)</i>
DAO	serious	GOR	firm	LIRA	mark <i>Latin littera (letter, mark)</i>
DAU	distance	HAI	message <i>Swahili habari (news, message)</i>	LITE	clock time <i>Greek λεπτό λεπτο (minute)</i>
DE	origin, from <i>Latin de (from, down from)</i>	HE	fiction tropes <i>Greek ἥρωϋς (heros = hero, trope figure)</i>	LIU	other <i>Latin alius (other)</i>
DEL	logic <i>Latin delineare (to draw out logically)</i>	HEH	antagonist tropes <i>English hex</i>	LOA	completeness <i>Hawaiian loa (very much, extremely)</i>
DETU	end	HEI	protagonist tropes <i>Mandarin hēi (hey, exclamation used to...</i>	LU	weather and atmosphere <i>Latin lux (light, sky phenomenon)</i>
DI	stripe, finger <i>Sanskrit diś (direction, to point)</i>	HELA	projecting outward <i>Sanskrit hel (to throw, sport)</i>	LUA	flow <i>Arabic lujja (deep flowing water)</i>
DO	regulations <i>Mandarin (dào = way, rule, principle)</i>	HEM	warmth	LUAN	tongue <i>Arabic liṣān (tongue)</i>
DOH	enforcement <i>Hausa dokar (regulation)</i>	HEO	background <i>Old English heofon (firmament, vault of...</i>	LUFU	air <i>German Luft (air)</i>
DOI	opposing <i>Arabic dīdd (opposing, against)</i>	HOH	extreme	LUN	seasons <i>Latin luna (moon, seasonal cycle)</i>
DOM	place <i>Latin domus (house, place, domain)</i>	HOU	shadow <i>Mandarin hòu (behind, back)</i>	MA	cooking food <i>Arabic (matbakh = kitchen)</i>
DON	show	HUE	haze	MAE	tubers and grains <i>Mandarin (mǐ = rice, grain)</i>
DORA	bond <i>Latin adorare (to be bound in devotion)</i>	HUI	ethereal <i>Mandarin hún (soul, spirit)</i>	MAL	bread and dairy <i>German Mehl (flour)</i>
DUR	hardness <i>Latin durus (hard, tough)</i>	IL	objects of inquiry <i>Latin ille (that thing, object of inquiry)</i>		
		ILA	sharing information <i>Arabic (ilā = toward, sharing direction)</i>		
		ILI	cognition <i>Portuguese/Spanish inteligencia (intellig...</i>		

● MAS	spices and seasonings <i>Arabic (masāla = spice blend)</i>	● RAI	governance <i>Hindi (rāj = rule, governance)</i>	● TOS	interpersonal suffering <i>Greek pathos (suffering, passion)</i>
●● MI	bigger animals <i>Swahili mnyama (animal, with m- animat...</i>	● RAM	sudden <i>Latin raptim (suddenly, rapidly)</i>	● TOU	physical depletion
● MIA	mixing	● RAN	media, public discourse <i>Hindi raṅgmanc (public stage)</i>	● TU	conflict <i>Latin tumultus (conflict, violent disorder)</i>
● MIE	appearance <i>Mandarin miàn (face, appearance)</i>	● RAS	about society <i>Arabic/Persian/Urdu rasm (social practic...</i>	● TUL	crash <i>English tumble</i>
● MIN	pleasure	● REL	up, high <i>Latin relevare (to lift, raise up)</i>	● TUM	weapons <i>Indonesian tombak (spear/weapon)</i>
● MIO	wild animals <i>Hindi mṛg (wild animal)</i>	● REN	honor <i>Mandarin rén (benevolence, honor)</i>	● VA	core <i>Sanskrit (vāyu = vital wind/breath)</i>
● MIR	lots of <i>Sanskrit mīr (leader of many)</i>	● REVA	accurate <i>Latin revelare (to reveal)</i>	● VABO	cozy, body home <i>va (body) + bo (home)</i>
● MIU	support	● RI	act	● VAL	ice <i>Italian valanga (snow mass), English/Fre...</i>
●● MO	food, eating <i>Hawaiian moku (to eat, archaic)</i>	● RIH	higher, rising	● VAN	limbs <i>Hindi (bāṃh = arm/limb)</i>
● MOA	fruits <i>Polynesian languages moa (banana plan...</i>	●● RO	knowledge <i>Japanese (ron = argument, theoretical k...</i>	●● VAR	face <i>Sanskrit vaktram (face/mouth)</i>
● MOL	food containers	● ROE	formal education <i>Latin rogare (formally proposing)</i>	● VARI	back <i>Arabic warā (behind, back)</i>
●● MU	smaller animals <i>Swahili mdudu (insect, bug)</i>	● ROU	written knowledge <i>Latin rotulus (scroll, written scroll)</i>	● VAS	private
● MUH	flying animals <i>Persian morgh (bird)</i>	● RU	bend <i>Arabic rukū (bowing, bending)</i>	● VEI	health issues <i>Sanskrit vaidya (physician)</i>
● NA	giving <i>Proto-Bantu *-nab-/*-na (to give)</i>	● RUL	habit <i>English rule</i>	● VEL	medical treatments <i>Latin valere (to be well/healthy)</i>
● NALA	urgency <i>Arabic nafara (urgent flight, alarm)</i>	● SAR	hang <i>Turkish sarkmak (to hang down)</i>	● VER	safety <i>German Wehr (defense, protection)</i>
●● NE	quantifiers <i>Swahili na (additive marker)</i>	● SARI	sun <i>Sanskrit sūrya (sun)</i>	●● VI	interior body <i>Proto-Bantu *-vim- (becoming thick)</i>
● NEN	power and violence <i>Latin imponens (imposing)</i>	● SAU	start <i>Hindi śūrū (start, beginning)</i>	● VIO	change, exchange <i>Latin via (road, path of change, exchange)</i>
● NI	new <i>Hindi nayā (new)</i>	● SE	machines <i>Mandarin (shèbèi = equipment)</i>	●● VIR	organs <i>Sanskrit vṛt (to proceed, method, proced...</i>
● NIU	some <i>Tagalog niyon/niyun (that)</i>	● SEL	coding <i>English select, cell</i>	● VOA	constraint <i>Mandarin wéi (enclose, surround)</i>
●● NO	function words <i>Latin non (negation, downward moveme...</i>	● SEM	system <i>Greek σύστημα systema (system)</i>	● VON	external body
● NON	path	● SERI	series <i>Latin series (sequence, series)</i>	● VOR	threat <i>English horror</i>
● NOR	relation to reference <i>Latin norma (standard, reference point)</i>	● SI	processes <i>PIE *sek- (to follow a sequence, to proce...</i>	● VOS	cleaning actions <i>Vietnamese vỏ (cover, shell, skin)</i>
● NOU	low, falling <i>Arabic nawm (sleep, falling into sleep)</i>	● SIO	games <i>Latin iocus (game, jest, play)</i>	● VU	movement <i>Mandarin bù (step, pace)</i>
● NU	limit <i>Greek vu nu (particle marking limits in a...</i>	● SIU	written record	● VUSON	slow movement <i>vu (move) + son</i>
● NYA	empty <i>Sanskrit śūnya (nothingness, emptiness)</i>	● SOI	speed <i>Vietnamese sớm (soon, early)</i>	●● WA	water, sea <i>Polynesian root wai (water)</i>
● ODU	top	● SU	alongside	● WI	geographical orientation <i>Arabic wayn = where?)</i>
● OI	fun <i>Yiddish/English oy (exclamation of feeling)</i>	● TA	hand <i>Latin tangere (to touch with hand)</i>	● WIL	human made geography <i>Latin villa (human settlement)</i>
● OM	music <i>Sanskrit om/aum (the primordial sound,...)</i>	● TAI	guide <i>Mandarin dài (lead)</i>	● WIM	natural geography
● ORA	idea	● TAL	door <i>Persian tāq (arch, doorway)</i>	● WOL	wide
● PA	paper <i>Latin papyrus (paper)</i>	● TALE	passage <i>Welsh taith (journey, passage)</i>	● WOWO	back-and-forth motion
● PAI	foot <i>Hindi pair (foot)</i>	● TAM	one <i>Arabic tamām (whole, one complete)</i>	●● YA	objective qualities <i>Swahili -a (Bantu adjectival linker)</i>
● PAN	achievement	● TAN	big <i>Greek titan (giant)</i>	● YAH	texture qualities
● PARO	front <i>Latin pro/prae (in front of, before)</i>	● TAR	regulate <i>Arabic tartīb (regulation, arrangement)</i>	●● YAL	size qualities <i>Arabic ṭawīl (long, tall, length)</i>
● PILI	delicate	● TEL	image <i>English television</i>	● YAR	light <i>Arabic diyā (radiant light)</i>
● PO	components <i>English portion</i>	● TEI	moment	● YE	clothing and fabric <i>Turkish yelken (sail/large expanse of fab...</i>
● POA	chemical <i>Mandarin (pào = bubble, chemical reacti...</i>	● TER	count <i>Latin ter (three times)</i>	● YEL	joining <i>English yoke</i>
●● POH	energy <i>Greek πῦρ (pyr = fire)</i>	● TI	harm, damage <i>Tamil (tī = fire, harm, danger)</i>	● YEN	printed <i>Mandarin yin (stamp, print mark)</i>
● POI	liquids	● TIRA	fungus	● YES	garments
● POPO	echo <i>onomatopoeia for hollow resonance/echo</i>	● TIU	types of harm <i>Sanskrit (tīva = severe, violent)</i>	● YI	sweet
● PU	loss, sadness <i>Persian pūc (emptiness, loss)</i>	●● TO	suffering, distress <i>Indonesian tobat (remorse, suffering fro...</i>	●● YO	colors <i>Yoruba yọ (to emerge)</i>
● PUNI	command <i>Latin punire (to punish, command obedi...</i>	● TOH	emotional suffering <i>English torment</i>	● YOL	sky and ocean
● PUPI	water falling <i>onomatopoeia for falling water</i>			● YU	subjective qualities
● RA	society <i>Sanskrit rastra (state, polity, society)</i>			● YUN	personal characteristics